

James O'Brien

Principal Cloud Architect · DevOps & Platform Engineering

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14

YRS EXPERIENCE

200+

CLOUD MIGRATIONS

\$60M

INFRA COST SAVED

12

CERTIFICATIONS

SUMMARY

Principal Cloud Architect with 14 years engineering and governing large-scale distributed infrastructure across AWS, Azure, and GCP. Deep expertise in hybrid cloud strategy, Kubernetes at enterprise scale, FinOps, and building platform engineering cultures. Led cloud transformations at Fidelity, Akamai, and HubSpot. Speaker at KubeCon, AWS re:Invent, and HashiConf.

EXPERIENCE

Fidelity Investments

Boston, MA

2021 – Present

Principal Cloud Architect

- Designed Fidelity's hybrid multi-cloud architecture spanning AWS + Azure + on-prem for 380 internal applications with 99.99% SLA requirements
- Led \$42M cloud modernization initiative migrating 120 legacy Java applications to cloud-native; delivered 40% OPEX reduction
- Built enterprise Kubernetes platform (EKS) supporting 4,000+ daily deployments across 200 development teams
- Architected FinOps practice reducing cloud spend from \$18M/month to \$10.8M/month via rightsizing, spot instances, and reserved capacity
- Designed zero-trust security architecture meeting FINRA, SOC2 Type II, and PCI-DSS requirements

Akamai Technologies

Cambridge, MA

2017 – 2021

Senior Platform Engineer → Staff Architect

- Designed Akamai's internal CI/CD platform handling 50,000+ deployments/day across 350,000+ edge servers worldwide
- Rebuilt service mesh using Envoy + Istio, reducing inter-service latency by 41% and eliminating 99% of manual certificate rotations
- Led Terraform IaC transformation; codified 400+ infrastructure modules used across all engineering teams
- Built chaos engineering program with 300+ automated fault injection experiments identifying and resolving 12 critical resilience gaps

HubSpot

Cambridge, MA

2014 – 2017

DevOps Engineer → Lead Cloud Engineer

- Drove HubSpot's migration from bare-metal to AWS; reduced provisioning time from 2 weeks to 20 minutes
- Built observability platform on ELK + Prometheus + Grafana; reduced MTTR from 4 hours to 18 minutes
- Implemented GitOps workflow with ArgoCD; increased deployment frequency by 8x

Rackspace

San Antonio, TX

2010 – 2014

Cloud Solutions Engineer

- Designed and implemented infrastructure solutions for 200+ enterprise customers across e-commerce, media, and finance verticals
- Developed automated capacity planning tools reducing over-provisioning by 30% across managed customer base

EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Engineering

Northeastern University

2012

B.E. Systems Engineering

University College Dublin

2009

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Solutions Architect – Professional
- AWS DevOps Engineer – Professional
- Google Professional Cloud Architect
- Azure Solutions Architect Expert
- Certified Kubernetes Admin (CKA)
- Certified Kubernetes Security (CKS)
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate
- HashiCorp Certified: Vault Associate

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CLOUD

AWS	Expert
Azure	Expert
GCP	Advanced

CONTAINERS

Kubernetes	Expert
Docker	Expert
Helm	Expert

IAC

Terraform	Expert
Pulumi	Advanced
CDK	Advanced

CI/CD

GitHub Actions	Expert
ArgoCD	Expert
Jenkins	Advanced

TOOLS & STACK

Python	Go	Ansible	Prometheus	Grafana	Datadog	Vault	Consul	Istio	Envoy	Kafka	PostgreSQL
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